GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

December 5th, 2025
Week 49
Volume 279, Issue 1214

Highlights:

- **Lacking.**
- **HKC boon.**
- **Upgrades work.**
- **Pak advances.**
- **Slowing supply.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

""If you don't risk anything, you risk even more."

– Erica Jong

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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TURKEY, AND HAM…STRUNG!

As we head into the traditionally quieter festive / Christmas season, ship recycling markets appear to be hamstrung on the back of a stubborn and persistent lack of meaningful tonnage, violently collapsing fundamentals that were promptly followed by declining offers, and all of this ongoing non-stop for nearly all of 2025 that has seen purchasing sentiment in a post-HKC world get crushed under the weight of it all.

To start, the onset of December brought with it a declining Baltic Exchange that saw the Dry Index fall by about 3%, this week, dragged down by mounting pressure across all segments that saw capes slipping 4.4%, panamax dropping 1.4%, and the smaller segments shedding 5 basis points, all while oil barely moved the needle as it closed another week at region USD 59.70/barrel (expected to breach USD 60/barrel in the coming week) and inflation reported minor improvements at a couple of key ship recycling destinations.

But it were financial currencies that really battered both India and Bangladesh, all while Turkey perennially decorated the top three of the declining currency marathon that it alone has been on. Not wanting to be left behind, local steel plate prices also fell by just under USD 5/ton across all sub-continent recycling destinations, leaving ship recyclers firmly holding off on further negotiations as the week ended.

As such, the lack of tonnage has delivered yet another characteristically low supply of vessels for a few weeks now, especially considering the lack of the occasional large LDT LNG vessels (with around 15 sold so far this year) drying up as freight rates continue to remain at elevated overall levels, thus depriving ship recyclers for yet another week. Further cementing this fact was the sheer lack of arrivals at every sub-continent ship recycling location – probably a true first in its own right.

Thankfully, compulsion has successfully driven remarkable developments across the Indian sub-continent ship recycling sector, with HKC infrastructure upgrades still ongoing and a confirmed 23 HKC-certified ship recycling yards now added to the existing sub-continent fleet of HKC certified yards – including Pakistan's first HKC approval that was announced just last week. Ever since the Hong Kong Convention came into force on June 26th earlier in the year, it has been encouraging to see increased investments and upgrades taking place at these new locations, ensuring a better and safer set of standards for responsible recycling.

Overall, 2025 will probably be the cherry-year of the last four and 2026 hopefully brings more tonnage and stability across the globe.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 49 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

WAIT CONTINUES!

Cooling off.

After a fruitful month of HKC progress that included an impressive couple of weeks of tonnage deliveries, the Bangladeshi ship recycling market seemed to rapidly cool this week, ensuring that any of the slim pickings of units making the rounds at the bidding tables continued to see lower overall levels now that most Chattogram recycling yards had taken in at least one unit across November.

Demand ripe.

Adding to the disappearing flavor of the local purchasing mindset has been the curated collective of fundamentals that mercifully timed their arrival this week, after all local deliveries had been completed as not only did the BDT lose 35 basis points against the U.S. Dollar ending the week at BDT 122.35, but local steel plate prices also fell by about USD 5/Ton to end the week at USD 502/Ton. Clearly afflicted by the recent performance of fundamentals and other than a sea of deliveries of tonnage that in fact arrived last week, not a single fresh unit greeted Chattogram's waterfront this week.

LNGs to arrive.

Through it all, and as stated in the Market Commentary above, HKC upgrades continue at pace locally as 22 ship recycling yards have now received their HKC accreditations since March this year and, as space slowly clears up on the back of declining plate levels that clearly suggest recycled material is now moving off local yards, local appetite seems to be getting its rumbles in what has historically been one of the busiest times of the year for businesses wanting to close their books.

Economically overall, inflation is expected to continue lingering around the high 8.x% range as an economic stagnation seems to fill the domestic environment, given that there have still not been any economic policies set in place to accelerate domestic growth by the interim government, which itself is aware of its impending dissolution come February 2026 on the back of the upcoming elections and a fresh new government finally taking the reins.

Silent Christmas.

In the interim, local recyclers will likely keep themselves busy with several of the larger LDT LNGs that have ended up in Bangladesh over the last few months (including HKC select yards only from both Seapeak and MISC). It seems like it's destined to be a silent Christmas after all.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

SET ADRIFT!

India has been set adrift at the bottom of the Indian subcontinent ship recycling price board as Alang recyclers seem to be losing hope of securing any standard, competitive ships any time soon – and rightly so, given that freight markets continue to soar at impressive highs.

Little hope.

Buckled tighter by the increasing number of vessels being added to the list of international sanctions and blacklists as governments globally battle for economic attrition against embattled nations, Alang's waterfront highlighted the situation incredibly well this week, with not a single fresh arrival reported.

Fundamentals have also been dragging the sentiment canoe down level 1 rapids as not only has the Indian Rupee depreciated against the U.S. Dollar once again by a massive 70 basis points and clock the week out at a deathly Rs. 89.96, but local steel plate prices also retreated a milder USD 4/Ton and end the week at nearly USD 387/Ton – clearly highlighting the upcoming levels of local offerings in the coming weeks.

Poleaxed.

Unlike their competing neighbours, most Alang yards have been HKC-approved for nearly a decade now, but the state of fundamentals has driven prices so low that local recyclers have simply been unable to hammer home the HKC advantage while competing markets are still having their yards upgraded and infrastructure brought up to HKC standards. Notwithstanding, Alang yards have been comparatively busier than their regional competition would seem to suggest.

No advantage.

Overall, until the supply of tonnage increases, there remains nothing to really report from these markets – other than the unfolding state of fundamentals.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

TAILGATING!

Primetime!

Prime Green Recyclers has become the first ever HKC-approved ship recycling yard not only in Gadani, but also the first facility to bring Pakistan into the international playground within 2025. And while progress reportedly continues locally at pace along with infrastructure upgrades, the rest of the sector remains in shambles as prices have largely tailgated India's (no surprise there), even though they remain higher on the market rankings.

But the double whammy brought on by both an overall scarcity of tonnage along with a prevailing scarcity of HKC-approved yards has left Gadani's anchorage empty once again this week – and that too for nearly a month now.

Brief spurt.

After a brief spurt of activity in September backed by comparatively decent levels of DASR assisted local deliveries, local fixtures have all but flatlined over recent weeks as end buyers continue their HKC development work and take stock of where the market may be heading next.

And rightly so, given that local steel plate prices continue to slip by the week as they fell nearly USD 5/Ton again and drifted further down to USD 575/Ton (from the highs of USD 650/Ton), as cheap Iranian imports continue to influence prevailing resale prices of recycled stock. Furthermore, the Pakistani Rupee miraculously firmed despite its depressed overall state as it gained an impressive 45 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and end the week at PKR 280.42.

Taking stock.

Overall, a lot of work still lies ahead for Pakistan's ship-recycling sector and the next batch of yards to achieve HKC approvals will probably be in Q1 2026, whilst several more yards in Bangladesh have infrastructure works underway and are expected to reach HKC status in the months ahead as well.

Slow times for slow times.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

Firming?

Russian Roulette.

A surprising couple of weeks not only saw import steel prices but even local steel plate prices firm by about USD 10/Ton, which in turn promptly transitioned to firmer levels from Aliaga recyclers that jumped by about USD 10/Ton as well.

What jumped as well was the value of the U.S. Dollar against the Turkish Lira, which slipped another 20 basis points and end the week at a disastrous TRY 42.55. Just how soon and effective will the government's intended economic measures to assist the Lira's value be, remains to be seen. Until then, it seems like Russian roulette with pricing, just to tempt in more tonnage.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 49 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

SPACED OUT!!

- ***Gamma-ray bursts release more energy in 10 seconds than our Sun in its entire life.*** *Nothing in the Universe rivals the power unleashed during a gamma-ray burst, a brief but incredibly intense flash of high-energy radiation. There are many types of gamma-ray burst. Some are thought to form when a massive star implodes; others when two neutron stars merge together.*
- ***There are stars we will never be able to see.*** *Ever since the Big Bang, most objects in space have been moving away from one another. In fact, the expansion of the Universe is actually accelerating. This is one of the facts about space that has really rocked the cosmological boat over the past few years, and it's known as dark energy. As regions of space are whizzing away from one another at an ever-increasing rate, the first population of stars to form in the Universe are now too far away for us to ever hope of spying them. And that's even using the best present or future telescope. Hope is not lost. We can attempt to spot them indirectly via the energetic bursts of radiation they emit at the end of their lives.*
- ***A day on Venus is longer than its year.*** *Venus has one of the slowest rotations in the Solar System. It takes about 243 Earth days to complete one full spin on its axis, but takes only 225 Earth days to orbit the Sun. This means a day on Venus – the time it takes to spin once – is longer than a year on Venus – the time it takes to orbit the Sun once. Even more bizarre, due to its 'backwards' spin, if you stood on the surface, the Sun would rise in the west and set in the east!*
- ***Black holes have theoretical opposites known as white holes.*** *Black holes are known for their voracious appetites; their influence is so strong that even light can't escape their gravity. But they have a theoretical converse – white holes. They are effectively the opposite of their dark relatives, spitting out light and matter instead of trapping it. So far, they are purely hypothetical objects; astronomers are contemplating how they could form in reality.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 24 – Christmas Eve December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – New Year's Eve	December 02 – December 10 December 18 – December 25

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 01 – 02 – Durga Puja December 16 – Victory Day December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – Bank Holiday	December 03 – December 06 December 21 – December 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
December 25 – Quaid-e-Azam	**No holidays in December**

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ALANG - Port Position as of December 05, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
Total Tonnage		20,001		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of December 05, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Nica*	*7,779*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered December 03*
2	*Patcharawadee 10*	*1,295*	*LPG*	*Delivered November 29*
3	*Patcharawadee 12*	*1,244*	*LPG*	*Delivered November 29*
4	*Patcharawadee 14*	*2,450*	*LPG*	*Delivered November 30*
5	*Star Advance*	*9,691*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered December 04*
		22,459		

GADANI - Port Position as of December 05, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported				
Total Tonnage		-		

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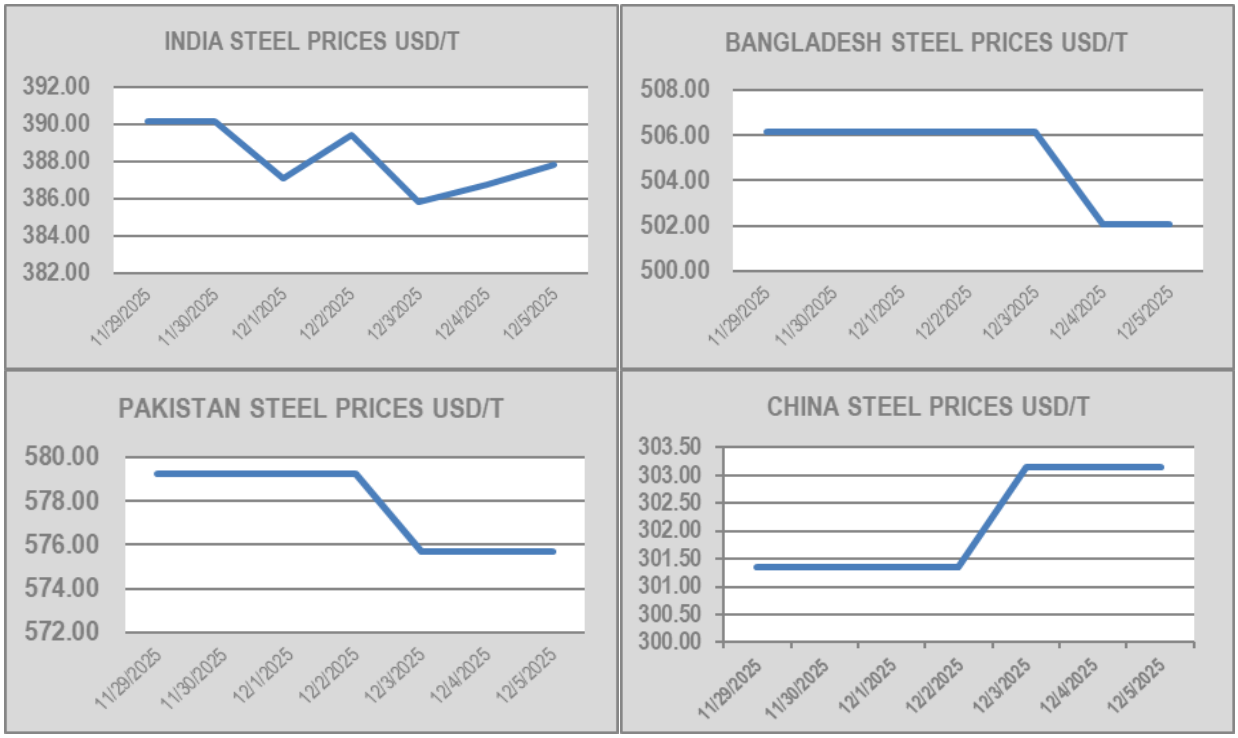
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
11/29/2025	390.16	34,900.00	579.25	163,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	301.35
11/30/2025	390.16	34,900.00	579.25	163,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	301.35
12/1/2025	387.10	34,800.00	579.25	163,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	301.35
12/2/2025	389.45	35,000.00	579.25	163,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	301.35
12/3/2025	385.85	34,800.00	575.69	162,000.00	506.17	61,500.00	303.16
12/4/2025	386.80	34,800.00	575.69	162,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.16
12/5/2025	387.86	34,900.00	575.69	162,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.16



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